

October 1, 2026 Stepping Down



“There is no success without a successor.” -John Maxwell

Today my relief arrives. My short stint back at work ends and, once again, I will ride slowly off into the sunset. I don't expect to return. I am not looking for any return- not for myself anyway- I've been compensated and rewarded already. But I do hope there is a return to the community that I served for all those years, and for these three additional months. Projects, culture, optimism, direction, and forethought that I like to think I helped foster and initiate will perhaps evolve into something new or better over time, but those contributions were always meant to be an act of faith. Faith- or fervent hopes perhaps- that they would be stepping stones in a path to a better future. A path that will be walked by successor generations tried and corrected and worn smooth by ever changing demands, new futures, reimaginings of what's possible. A path toward what's right, and what builds the bonds of community. But, without someone to carry on and then to pass along the work and the years will have been all for naught. I inherited a community with a legacy of success, of a future vision and commitment, of caring and engagement, and I hope that I am passing this forward a generation later not just as it was, but benefited by my custodial time and with the same foundations onto which I helped build. I never worked alone.

There are tough times ahead---I don't recall any times when that was not true. Yet faith that “better days are coming” keeps us working to build that better day to be shared. I have both confidence and hopeful optimism that things are left in good hands and in good faith. And never forget---these **are** the good old days! Carry on.

Happy Thinksday